

AI TEAM NORMS

The AI said something different.

The person who built the system was still mid-sentence.

That moment is not an accuracy problem. It is an authority problem.

Why the AI answer sounds right and isn't.

- The model was trained on documentation from a point in time.
- It knows the vendor spec. It does not know what your team changed.
- A renamed parameter, a moved config file, a process your ops lead rewrote — all invisible to the model.

Complete confidence. Outdated information. No contradiction in either.

CONFLICT TYPE 1

AI confidence vs. the person who owns the system.

The rule

The owner of the system is the final authority on how the system currently works. Not the vendor guide. Not the AI summary of the vendor guide.

AI is reliable on general product knowledge. Unreliable on anything your team has touched.

CONFLICT TYPE 2

AI confidence vs. the documentation.

Which doc controls?

Internal docs beat public vendor docs for how your team operates.
Public vendor docs beat AI recollection for current product behavior —
but only within the version range the model is likely to know.

If you run a newer version than the model knows, go to the actual changelog. Not the AI summary.

CONFLICT TYPE 3

When the owner is not in the room.

- AI is useful as a first draft. Not as a final answer.
- Flag it explicitly: "This is what AI says. The owner is not on this call. Treat it as provisional."
- A provisional flag prevents a confident AI answer from becoming a permanent team assumption built on outdated information.

That framing is not weakness. It is how you avoid shipping the wrong thing twice.

THE ONE QUESTION THAT ENDS IT

Is this about our system or how the product works generally?

Our system

Goes to the person who owns it. Full stop.

General product behavior

At first, with a quick version check. Acceptable starting point.

One question. Thirty seconds. Eliminates most of the conflict.

THE RULE CARD

One card. Three questions. Agreed before the meeting.

| Our system or general product?

| Who owns this system and can we get them now?

| Does the AI answer predate any changes we know about?

That third question is the one teams always skip. It catches the most wrong answers.

full/REFIT

Get the Conflict-Resolution rule card.

One page. Three questions. Covers all three conflict types and drops you onto the team AI-capability diagnostic.

Get the free rule card

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